

Presentation Notes V2

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This is to be worked on and shaped to my liking

You have a fantastic foundation here. For an intercultural communication presentation, the secret to making these points punchy is moving away from just “raw numbers” and focusing on the so-what factor—how these elements actually impact human behavior, power dynamics, and professional relationships.

Since you just looked into Hofstede’s Cultural Dimensions, we can anchor your ideas directly into that framework to give them massive academic weight and practical clarity. Elevating Your Current Points 1. Language: From “Counting” to “Socio-Political Power”

Your Angle: Number of languages spoken.

How to give it power: Don't just list the numbers; contrast Hyper-Fragmentation with Bipolar Dynamics.

Cameroon: Features over 250 indigenous languages alongside an official English/French bilingual split. Because no single native language dominates, English and French act as institutional bridges, but also introduce distinct regional and political professional dynamics.

Sri Lanka: Dominated primarily by two major localized languages-Sinhala and Tamil-with English acting as a neutral commercial link.

Presentation Punchline: Language in Cameroon is a vast mosaic used to navigate hundreds of micro-cultures; in Sri Lanka, it is a consolidated pillar of distinct national identities.

2. Ethnic Groups: Mosaic vs. Majoritarianism

Your Angle: Number of ethnic groups.

How to give it power: Focus on how ethnic distribution changes collaboration.

Cameroon: A true ethnic mosaic (Bamileke, Beti, Fulani, Sawa, etc.) where compromise and coalition-building are inherently baked into daily survival and business. No single group has a massive outright majority.

Sri Lanka: A majoritarian structure (Sinhalese form roughly 75% of the population, alongside prominent Tamil and Moor communities).

Presentation Punchline: Professional dynamics in Cameroon require managing highly decentralized tribal networks, whereas in Sri Lanka, they require navigating deeply rooted, historically distinct socio-cultural blocs.

3. Social Fabric & Identity: The Nature of Collectivism

Your Angle: Family, community ties, and how self-perception works.

How to give it power: Both nations score incredibly high on Hofstede’s Collectivism, but the anchors of their collectivism are different.

Cameroon (Lineage & Kinship): Identity is rooted in the extended family and ancestral village network ("I am because we are"). Professional loyalty often extends to supporting the broader community network.

Sri Lanka (Devotion & Hierarchy): Collectivism is deeply intertwined with religious

frameworks (Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam) and a structured respect for social hierarchy.

Presentation Punchline: A Cameroonian professional identifies heavily with their regional lineage and kinship network; a Sri Lankan professional often views their identity through the lens of spiritual duty, family honor, and societal roles.

4. Communication: Reframing the “Broad” Topic

Your Angle: How people talk and interact.

How to give it power: Narrow this down specifically to High-Context vs. Low-Context and Saving Face.

Both cultures are High-Context, meaning how something is said matters more than the literal words.

In both Cameroon and Sri Lanka, open confrontation or a blunt "no" in a professional setting is considered deeply disrespectful. Disagreements are handled through diplomatic indirectness, non-verbal cues, and post-meeting side conversations to preserve harmony.

New Power Points to Add

To round out your presentation slide, here are two highly relevant professional dynamics to introduce:
Power Distance in the Workplace

The Contrast: Both cultures respect hierarchy, but express it differently. In Sri Lanka, respect for authority is quiet, deeply deferential, and influenced by traditional structures. In Cameroon, leadership is often expected to be more assertive, visible, and expressive—a boss is expected to look and act like a decisive leader.

Time Orientation (Fluid vs. Structured)

The Contrast: Both cultures skew heavily Polychronic (relationship-driven time over rigid schedules). However, navigating professional dynamics means understanding that a meeting delay in Cameroon might be due to unexpected community/kinship obligations, whereas in Sri Lanka, it might bend around personal or auspicious family/religious milestones.